TOWN OF THUNDERBOLT
REGULAR MONTHLY MEETING
WEDNESDAY, JUNE 8, 2022
6:00 PM

AGENDA HEARING

Beth Goette, 3006 Leonard St., asked why the Council is changing the meeting schedule for Planning and Zoning without notifying the P & Z Board. Town Attorney explained this is the start of the process. The ordinance changes will be to allow for more flexibility to hold meetings to shorten the time frame for citizens before final approval from Council.

Jan Yarbrough, 24 Bonaventure Rd, asked about the new meeting procedure, if it is recorded. Mayor Williams explained it is being recorded.

Nicole Register, 3407 Bannon Dr, stated she is against Mr. Johnson's petition to rezone his property to River Drive District. The area is residential and should stay residential.

Geneve Golden, 3126 Gilbert St., asked for explanation on all the acronyms being used on the agenda. Town Administrator went through the agenda and stated what each acronym meant.

Mayor Williams thanked all those who attended the Blessing of the Fleet. He thanked staff for their hard work. He thanked Council for their support, all the volunteers and the museum for their help. He stated an estimated 3,000 people attended. They are looking to expand more for next year, i.e. if possible a beauty contest and street dancing.

Mayor Williams closed the public hearing at 6:30 pm

REGULAR MEETING

1. **Call to order**

   Mayor Williams opened the business meeting at 6:32 pm.

2. **Roll Call by Presiding Officer with Invocation, followed by the Pledge of Allegiance**

   Those in attendance was Mayor Dana Williams and Council Members: Brooks Barbaree, James Lavin, Ed Drohan, Larry Ward, David Crenshaw and Bethany Skipper-Greer. Staff in attendance was Town Administrator, Bob Milie; Town Attorney, Charlie Barrow; Clerk of Council, Deatre Denion, Fire Chief, Andrew Bateman,

Police Chief, Sean Clayton; Accounts Payable/Utility Manager; Katina Spaulding and Public Works Manager, Oscar Crosby.

3. **Approval of Meeting Agenda**
Mayor Williams asked for a motion and a second to approve the agenda. **Council Member Ward made the motion with a second from Council Member Crenshaw. The motion passed unanimously.**

4. **Approval of Minutes from Previous Meeting**:
Minutes of May 11, 2022

Mayor Williams asked for a motion to approve the May 11, 2022 meeting minutes. **Council Member Ward made the motion with a second from Council Member Skipper-Greer. The motion passed unanimously.**

5. **Presentations:**

a) **Finance Report/Audit Update:**

Shannon Brett – – The final draft of the audit was received, and Attorney Barrow has issued the legal letter. June 30th is when the audit has to be submitted to DCA. The audit had no findings.

6. **Public Hearing for Planning and Zoning**

a) **Petitioner:** Jason T. Johnson
Request: Rezone from R-1 to RDD
Parcel Involved: 3-0006-17-001
Location: 3403 Bannon Drive
P & Z voted to deny

The petitioner wants to rezone their property from R-1 to RDD. Planning & Zoning denied the request.

Nicole Register, 3407 Bannon Dr., opposed the rezoning.

Jan Yarbourgh, 24 Bonaventure Ave, stated she was a P & Z member at the time of the creating of River Drive District. There was no intention to have the other side of Bannon Dr be commercial.

Maury Gallaher, 25 Bonaventure Ave, asked about short term rental. Town Clerk Denion explained short term rental has no bearing on the zoning.

Council Member Drohan made a motion to deny the petition and uphold P & Z recommendation. Council Member Lavin seconded the motion. The motion passed unanimously.

b) **Petitioner:** Release Properties
Request: Rezone from R-2 to P-B
Parcel Involved: 3-0003-01-112
Location: 2100 Roger Lacey Ave

P & Z voted to approve

This petition is rectifying a clerical error. This parcel was mistakenly assigned R-2 when it should have been P-B zoning. **Council Member Drohan made a motion to approve the request of the rezoning of 2100 Roger Lacy. Council Member Ward seconded the motion. The motion passed unanimously.**

7. **Consent Agenda:**

   a) **Approval of Renewal of Home Occupation Permit for Masonry Masters, 302 Laurel Oak Lane**

   b) **Approval of Department Head Salaries**

Mayor Williams asked for a motion to approve the Consent Agenda. **Council Member Drohan made a motion to approve the consent agenda with a second from Council Member Lavin. The motion passed unanimously.**

8. **Discussion Agenda**

   a) **Discussion of Tuberson Road Closure**

Town Administrator Milie stated there are pictures before them of what the Town could do with Tuberson. This started with an issue with Bannon Dr. First were temporary speed bumps, then Tuberson was closed. By closing Tuberson there was an impact to private properties. The Tuberson blockade has been removed. Police will be stepping up enforcement on trucks. Mayor Williams stated before he came into office he was working on this issue. Town Administrator Milie and Mayor Williams have invested a huge amount time into this issue. It is a public road and we can't prevent traffic from coming through. The Town can't put Police and speed bumps on every street. Council Member Drohan stated the issues brought forth are to stop trucks from coming through or driving on private property. The recommendation from Council Member Drohan is an island with enough clearance to allow cars through but not trucks. There also needs to be a truck route created. There are more roads that are more applicable to having trucks. Council Member Drohan asked Town Attorney Barrow about using public money to improve private property. Town Attorney Barrow stated you cannot on private property but a right of way you may. Town Administrator Milie recommended to wait until the next meeting. The barricade just came down and the Town can try a temporary island. Council Member Drohan stated he agreed with the recommendation but does want Town Administrator Milie to start working on a truck route**. Council Member Crenshaw made a motion to place a temporary sign and island on Tuberson for 30 to 60 days. Council Member Drohan seconded the motion. The motion passed unanimously.**

   b) **Approval of HVAC Contractor for Fire Department**

Town Administrator Milie stated three bids were submitted. $8,190 from Gordon; $14,000 from JT and $10, 770 from Edge. Town Administrator Milie recommended accepting the low bid from Gordon. **Council Member Ward made a motion to accept the recommendation with a second Council Member Crenshaw. The motion passed unanimously.**

   c) **Approval of HVAC Contractor for Server Room**

Town Administrator Milie stated this is one of Council's 2022 goals. There were three bids for a split unit to allow the door to the server room to be closed. Edge: $5,326.35; Gordon's: $7,337 and JT's: $11,000. Town Administrator Milie made the recommendation to not go with low bid. Gordon's was the only bid who proposed a cooling system design for server rooms. This type of system will not turn off when it is

cooler outside. **Council Member Ward made a motion to accept Gordon in hopes of negotiation for a lower price due to awarding them on both projects. Council Member Skipper-Greer seconded the motion. The motion passed unanimously.**

d) **Approval of Retroactive 2021 Police Dept. Seizure Budget**

Town Administrator Milie explained this was a recommendation from the 2020 audit. This is where if CNT seizes more than their operational budget and the overage is shared among the other municipalities. This does not usually happen. **Council Member Crenshaw made a motion to accept as rendered and was seconded by Council Member Ward.** Council Member Drohan asked what is the funding utilized for? Town Administrator Milie explained it can only be used for Police. **The motion passed unanimously.**

e) **Approval of 2022 Police Dept. Seizure Budget**

Town Administrator Milie stated the 2022 Seizure Budget is the cost of a fingerprint scanner. Currently, Police have to use one from Savannah. Council Member **Crenshaw made the motion to approve with a second from Council Member Skipper-Greer. The motion passed unanimously.**

f) **Approval of SPLOST Budget**

Town Administrator Milie stated the Town is not required to have a SPLOST Budget but the auditors want a budget. If Council decides to move on Shell Road, a budget amended will be needed. **Council Member Ward made a motion to approve the SPLOST budget with a seconded by Council Member Crenshaw. The motion passed unanimously.**

g) **Allocation of 2021 & 2022 ARPA Funding**

American Rescue Plan Act is COVID funding. None of the money has been spent. The Town has already received $489,000 and will receive another $489,000. Town Administrator Milie recommended this funding be used as salaries until it is all expended. Council Member Drohan stated we are just shifting the line on the budget but wanted to know if there would be any problems to use with SPLOST funding. Town Administrator Milie stated there would not be. Council Member Skipper-Greer asked if legal had approved this. Town Administrator Milie explained he had not run it through with Town Attorney Barrow since Georgia Municipal Association recommended them to use the funding this way. **Council Member Crenshaw made the motion to approve as presented with Council Member Ward seconded the motion. The motion passed unanimously.**

9. **Town Administrator Report:** Town Administrator, Bob Milie

Town Administrator Milie stated he has been here for a year now and to describe the year, it is like the Blessing of the Fleet. Council, citizens and staff were all in. In July there will be a follow up from the coordinator.

There are plans to have two hurricane workshops for the citizens of Thunderbolt.

Thunderbolt Safe and Tidy monthly clean up went well. There was one truck full of litter. Mayor Williams stated he was working in his yard and there was a couple picking up trash. They told him with all the beautifications happening in the Town they wanted to do their part. Council Member Crenshaw stated he drove by the school and saw Town Administrator Milie picking up trash.

10. **Department Report** – Written Reports Submitted

by: Police / Municipal Court / Neighborhood Watch – Sean Clayton, Chief of Police

The Police Department passed their audits. There have been some recent spikes in entering auto. Police did not give up on it and found the culprit. The speed cameras on Whatley are in the final permitting stage. The only change is the school zone time to go with the new school bell times. The monitoring will be from 6:30 am to 3:30 pm after feed back from other communities. Mayor Williams asked will it run when school is out. Chief Clayton stated not on weekends and during the summer. Council Member Drohan asked if it will be collecting data but not ticketing. Chief Clayton explained it will. Council Member Ward asked if they see more speeding will they change the hours. Chief Clayton stated it can be tweaked. Chief Clayton stated the time comes from the traffic engineers.

Fire –Fire Chief, Andrew Bateman

Mayor Williams stated the Fire Chief left the hospital and came straight to work the Blessing of the Fleet. Town Administrator Milie explained Jasmin and Taylor Roads are by subscription for Fire and Rescue. He explained with SSU being closed, it is not as effective service. The County and Savannah have pitched their services to the residents.

Public Works Department – Oscar Crosby, Public Works Manager

Town Administrator Milie stated the most feedback was about Public Works and their attention to detail. Public Works helped a vendor who had to breakdown quickly and get to a sick child. Council Member Barbaree stated he was out the next day after the event and the area was so clean.

11. **Legal Report – Town Attorney**
    a) First Reading of Planning & Zoning Meeting Change

Town Attorney Barrow explained this is a first reading to proposal a change to the zoning ordinance to allow more meeting times. Change wording to "may meet more often".

12. **Mayor and Council –**
    a) Water & Sewer Committee – Council Member Drohan

Town Administrator Milie spoke on Shell Road. Staff are now in the process of modifying the three LMEGS. There needs to slip lining of the sewer and water line replacement. P & Z has asked staff to come back with detail data on the area.

Council Member Drohan participated in an electrification meeting. The idea is to replace gas vehicles with electrical vehicles. Several municipalities demonstrated with their police dept to save money using electrical vehicles. There were other conversations for renewable options in the town. Thunderbolt's Citizens Conservation Committee has 16 people. They had their first zoom meeting. The committee talked about being a resource for the Town. The Town needs to start a discussion to consider sewage limits. Due to the cost of property, there are developers wanting more density. As a Council we need to be aware of these issues and aware of the prices.

Ana Maria Thomas gave an update on museum. They made $2,400 at the Blessing of the Fleet. They have been able to recruit new memberships. June 25th is the next bizarre. There is plans for a spaghetti dinner in September.

Council Member Skipper-Greer stated at the last CMA meeting there was a discussion on recreation centers and talking with the School Board. Mayor Williams stated he has been working on that for six months.

Council Member Skipper-Greer asked about movie and concert planning. Town Administrator Milie stated there will be a July kids' movie night and in August there will be a small concert.

Mayor Williams asked for a motion to move into Executive Session. **Council Member Ward made the motion with a second by Council Member Drohan. The motion passed unanimously.**

13. **Executive Session-** Mayor requests a motion and a second to recess into executive session for the purpose of Legal, Real Estate and/or Personnel matters.

    Mayor Williams asked for a motion to move back into regular session. The motion was made by Council Member Crenshaw with a second from Council Member Ward. The motion passed unanimously.

    Mayor Williams asked for a motion to adjourn. Council Member Crenshaw made the motion with a second from Council Member Ward.

14. **Adjournment:**

    The meeting was adjourned at 8:32 pm

Mayor, Dana Williams

Clerk of Council, Deatre N. Denion